



Instagram's dirty secret

How everyone's favourite photosharing app and network isn't playing fair. An investigation: <http://dgit.in/1hjoGZR>



DirectX 12 kicks ass

Microsoft touts performance improvements for existing hardware in DirectX 12. New API offers more low-level GPU access. <http://dgit.in/1drdTBI>

the repeated reports of the behavior of the US government. When our engineers work tirelessly to improve security, we imagine we're protecting you against criminals, not our own government.

The US government should be the champion for the internet, not a threat. They need to be much more transparent about what they're doing, or otherwise people will believe the worst.

I've called President Obama to express my frustration over the damage the government is creating for all of our future. Unfortunately, it seems like it will take a very long time for true full reform.

So it's up to us – all of us – to build the internet we want. Together, we can build a space that is greater and a more important part of the world than anything we have today, but is also safe and secure. I'm committed to seeing this happen, and you can count on Facebook to do our part.

Clouds just got cheaper

Google has upped the competition in the cloud storage segment as it slashes the prices of Drive monthly storage plans.

Google is now offering its 100 GB plan for just \$1.99, which was previously priced at \$4.99. For 1TB, Google has more lucrative offer. It's now available at \$9.99, earlier it was priced \$49.99. Google's 10TB plan is now available with option of



adding more space, starting at \$99.99. For 20TB storage, you have to shell out \$199.00 a month, while 30 TB is available for \$299.99. The standard 15GB drive is still free.

On the other hand, Dropbox offers 2GB of space free, while extra storage starts \$9.99 a month for 100GB while Box gives you 10GB of free storage off the bat, and charges \$5 a month for 100GB. "Whether it's all the footage of your kids' baseball games, the novel you're working on, or even just your grocery list for the week, we all have files that are too important to lose," says Google Drive's Director of Product Management, Scott Johnston, wrote in a blog post.

"Today, thanks to a number of recent infrastructure improvements, we're able to make it more affordable for you to keep everything safe and easy to reach on any device, from anywhere." If you are an already paid Google Drive user, Google will upgrade your plan at no additional cost.

Google has so far made several efforts to ensure its cloud storage offering is more convenient and affordable for users. It allows users to view attachments and save files to Drive right from Gmail.

No more @replies: Will Twitter break?

Micro blogging site Twitter is experimenting with a new version of its Android app that removes @ replies entirely. Vivian Schille, Twitter's Head

Of News hinted such a possibility at a recent event.

According to reports, Schiller recently stated that hashtags and @replies are "arcane," while speaking at the Newspaper Association of America's mediaXchange conference in Denver. She hinted that they may be removed soon from the service to provide a more 'streamlined' approach to help new users understand the concept of Twitter.

Schiller has since downplayed her comments, but a recent screenshot from the alpha version of Twitter for Android suggests that @replies may be removed in favour of Facebook-like mentions, although it is only an experiment at this point and there is no suggestion that regular @ mentions are affected. The thinking behind the change is that new users may find Twitter easier to understand with the removal of the @ replies and hashtags, but loyal users are quite likely to protest against such changes.

Twitter currently has 241 million monthly active users, an increase of just 3.8% over the previous quarter. In its financial results of the fourth quarter, the microblogging site has registered a decline in its user base which earlier grew at 10% in the beginning of 2013. Twitter's advertising revenue was \$220 million an increase of 121% y-o-y.

YouTube reportedly going under-10

Internet giant Google is reportedly building a version of YouTube just for kids under 10 years. According to reports, YouTube has even gauged the interests of video producers willing to create child-oriented content for the online video platform.

The Kids-friendly version of YouTube will not require con-

stant monitoring by parents over what content their child sees. The goal will be to offer a site to parents that will be free of both videos and comments that may not be child oriented. Parents could, for example, access a special app on a device or TV that includes only kid-safe videos.

YouTube already has a "safety" mode for filtering out inappropriate content as well as YouTube EDU, for educational videos for schools. However both the modes contain advertising that can sometimes



be questionable and parents can't ensure that the content is specially tailored for a specific age group.

According to reports, YouTube for kids is still in the development phase and no details have been mentioned on how it will work. One possibility is that the usual ads on the video platform may be removed or at least tailored to suit child oriented content.

A representative from YouTube also said the following about the news: "While we're always working on new and better ways for people to enjoy YouTube, we do not comment on rumour or speculation."

YouTube has over 1 billion unique users per month that watch over 6 billion hours of video. The online video platform has starting monitoring video views and content for artificially inflating video counts. The move will ensure that advertising campaigns on the site reach the target audience. The portal has started specializing and is expected to launch a music streaming service in 2014 as well. 

